

Lesson Learned: Pre-emptive Weight-Up in Deepwater Transition Zones (illustrative)

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Context & Finding

Relying on mud weight increases after penetrating overpressured deepwater sands guarantees a kick due to high transmissibility and fast drilling breaks. Transition zones must be identified early via sonic slowness excursions ($DT > 8 \text{ s/ft}$) and Eaton exponent reversals, triggering weight-up at least 20 m above sand contact.